



Oak View



DCG Core Values	What's happening at Oak View
Collaborative <i>Building a culture of teamwork and shared purpose to achieve our goals.</i>	This month we held a professional development for our staff that was led by our GTS teacher and Kate Boonstra from the AEA. Teachers were able to identify an area of enrichment or extension that was most interesting to them and learn about it in a small group session. We continue to ensure ways for staff to have time to work together during the day, one of the ways that we do this is by having a dedicated PLC period during their schedule so teachers will be able to meet and collaborate.
Passionate <i>Championing the success, well-being, and growth of every student with unwavering commitment.</i>	We started our service learning projects this month. Service learning is such a big deal for me because it helps our students think beyond themselves and find ways to help the school community. Students sign up for the service learnings that they would like and then we place them in one of their top choices. Students then spend 7 days, over 3 weeks, engaged in activities that benefit others. (See "supportive" for examples of our service learning at Oak View.



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Innovative <i>Embracing creativity to meet diverse needs and challenges.</i>	We are currently training a small group of 7th and 8th grade students to help with our 6th grade transition days. We have invited our 6th grade class over to Oak View over 3 total days. The first day is for our students with IEPs. We want them to be able to experience the transition in a small group to start. Then students with IEPs will come over again with all students a few weeks later. We feel that being at Oak View multiple times will help with their transition, and can help them feel more at ease. All students will then come to Oak View over two days (split by pods) and will have a fun experience, get a tour of the building, and learn a little bit about what Oak View is all about.
Inclusive <i>Creating a community where every student feels valued, respected, and empowered.</i>	Everyday we have an Oak View student read the announcements and pledge. We do this at the start of advisory and offer all students the ability to do this. Mrs. Burditt is preparing a couple of students in the level 3 special education classroom to help with the announcements. She has paired each student with a general education peer who has developed friendships with the students in her classroom. The general education students will be reading the general announcements, while our special education students will be doing the pledge. The twist to this is that the students reading the pledge are non-verbal, so they will be using their AAC device to read the pledge. We are so excited that Mrs. Burditt has thought of a way to include all of our students in this opportunity.
Supportive <i>Ensuring every student has the academic, social, and emotional support they need to prepare for their future.</i>	Students have found many ways to support others during service learning. This is an important skill for 7th and 8th grade students. According to Phyllis Fagell, author of <i>Middle School Superpowers</i>, service learning acts as a vital "antidote to helplessness" for adolescents by fostering Super Agency. By shifting focus from personal insecurities to community needs, these programs help students build resilience, develop real-world



problem-solving skills, and gain a tangible sense of competence and purpose during their most formative years.

Some of our service learning opportunities include:

- Courtyard Beautification (students clean up the courtyards)
- Courtyard Mural (students paint the cement in the courtyard)
- Kid Court Bags (students put together quiet activity bags to donate for kids in court)
- Tie Blankets for kids (students create tie blankets for other kids)
- Self Care Strategies and Wellness Workshop (students learn strategies to help themselves or others)
- Mustang Mentors (where our students mentor 4th grade students)
- DCG Game Day (where students plan Game Day for special education students in our district)
- Kindness for Kennybrook (students make cards and then visit Kennybrook)
- ARL (students make toys for animals and then visit the ARL to learn about the program)
- Comfort Care (students learn about period poverty and stock bathrooms with feminine products)
- T-Shirt Bags (students learn about the Food Bank of Iowa, make t-shirt bags, and donate them back to the Food Bank of Iowa)
- Staff May Day Baskets (students make May Day bags and fill them with treats for staff to show appreciation)
- Library Glow Up (students help our school librarian get books ready to be re-shelved)
- Student Ambassadors of Belonging (students learn about leadership and then plan 6th grade transition day and tours)
- Book Drive (students collect books to donate to local medical clinics to be handed out to kids)
- Student Tutoring Videos (students create video tutorials for future students)



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| | <ul style="list-style-type: none">• Music at Kennybrook (students will learn music to play at Kennybrook and Spurgeon Manor) |
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